

How AI is helping businesses save time and money amid tariff chaos

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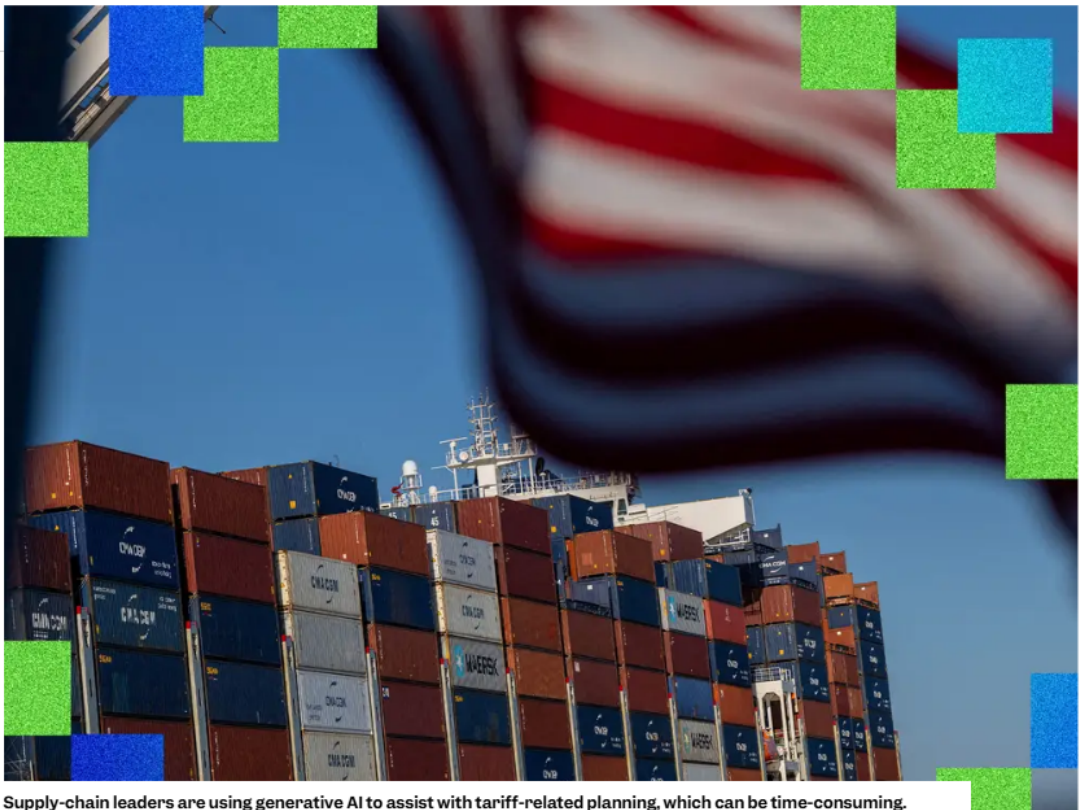
HOW AI IS CHANGING EVERYTHING: SUPPLY CHAIN

A series exploring the companies, leaders, and workers who are at the forefront of the AI supply-chain revolution.

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How AI is helping businesses save time and money amid tariff chaos

By [Shefali Kapadia](#)



Supply-chain leaders are using generative AI to assist with tariff-related planning, which can be time-consuming.
Carlos Barria/Reuters

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- <https://www.businessinsider.com/ai-helps-us-businesses-manage-supreme-court-tariff-impacts-2026-4?>

Main Findings

- The article explains how companies are increasingly using artificial intelligence to improve **procurement and supply chain decision-making**, particularly in response to changing tariffs and trade regulations. AI tools can rapidly analyze large datasets, including tariff structures, supplier pricing, and global trade conditions, allowing businesses to make more informed sourcing decisions.
- A key finding is that AI significantly improves efficiency by reducing the time required for procurement analysis. Tasks that traditionally took weeks—such as evaluating suppliers or assessing tariff impacts—can now be completed in minutes. This enables companies to quickly adapt to economic changes and optimize costs.
- The article also argues that AI is shifting procurement from a reactive process to a **proactive, data-driven strategy**, where businesses can simulate different scenarios and identify the most cost-effective sourcing options before making decisions.

Broader Implications for Society

- The use of AI in procurement and supply chains has broader implications for society, particularly in terms of **economic efficiency, globalization, and workforce changes**. By enabling companies to operate more efficiently, AI can reduce costs, stabilize supply chains, and improve the availability of goods.
- However, this increased automation may also lead to changes in the workforce. Traditional procurement roles may evolve, requiring workers to develop skills in **data analysis, AI tools, and strategic decision-making** rather than manual sourcing processes.
- Additionally, AI-driven procurement increases reliance on global data and digital systems, raising concerns about **data accuracy, cybersecurity, and over-dependence on automated decision-making**. If AI systems produce incorrect recommendations, it could lead to supply disruptions or financial losses.

Relevance and Potential Influence on the Construction Industry

- The concepts discussed in the article have strong relevance to the construction industry, where procurement and supply chain management are critical to project success. AI tools could help construction firms optimize sourcing decisions for materials such as steel, concrete, and mechanical systems by analyzing price fluctuations, supplier availability, and logistics in real time.
- For example, contractors and VDC professionals could use AI to:
- Compare suppliers and material costs across regions
- Adjust procurement strategies based on tariffs or shortages
- Forecast material price changes and availability
- Improve coordination between procurement schedules and construction timelines
- This would lead to more efficient project delivery, reduced costs, and fewer delays. However, similar to other industries, construction firms would need to ensure **data reliability and oversight**, as incorrect AI-driven decisions could impact budgets, schedules, and overall project performance.